

CS405 Lab 0: Set Up Your Computer

Sep 28, 2026 · @Mohammad

Do these steps before the lab on Sep 30, 2026 .

Note: Installation steps are different for each operating system, so each step links to the tool's official page. There you can find the installer and instructions for your OS (Windows, macOS or Linux).

Step 1: Install Google Chrome

Download and install Chrome from google.com/chrome. If you already have it, update it by opening `chrome://settings/help`.

Step 2: Enable WebGPU in Chrome

1. In Chrome's address bar, type `chrome://flags/#enable-unsafe-webgpu` and press Enter.
2. Set **Unsafe WebGPU Support** to **Enabled**.
3. Click **Relaunch**.

Step 3: Create a GitHub account and install Git

1. Create an account at github.com/signup. Skip this if you already have one.
2. Install Git from git-scm.com/downloads with the default options. On a Mac, instead open Terminal, type `git --version`, and click **Install**.
3. To check, open a new terminal and type `git --version`. It should print a version number.

Step 4: Install Node.js

1. Download the **LTS** version from nodejs.org and install it with the default options.
2. To check, open a new terminal and type `node -v`. It should print a version number.

Step 5: Install VS Code

We will use VS Code as our main code editor in the labs. You may use your preferred editor instead.

Download and install VS Code from code.visualstudio.com with the default options.

Step 6: Check that everything works

1. Open a new terminal and type these one at a time. Each should print a version number (`node -v` should show v22.12 or higher):

```
node -v
npm -v
git --version
```

2. In Chrome, open the [WebGL & WebGPU Checker](#). WebGPU should show **Supported**.
3. Also in Chrome, open `chrome://gpu` and find the **WebGPU** line. It should say **Hardware accelerated**.

If any check fails, don't worry. Bring your laptop to the lab and we will diagnose it together with the TA.